

Scratch — Events

Lesson Handout: "When Key Pressed"

What Are Events?

An **event** is something that happens. In real life, a doorbell ringing makes you open the door, or an alarm going off makes you wake up. In Scratch, events tell the computer: *"When THIS happens, do THAT!"*

Scratch Events Blocks

Events blocks live in the **Events category** (the yellow/orange tab). Some important ones include:

- When green flag clicked
- When this sprite clicked
- When [space] key pressed

Today's focus: **"When [] key pressed"**

Which Keys Can We Use?

You can pick from many keys, and each key can do something different:

- Letters: a, b, c ... z
- Arrow keys: up, down, left, right
- Space bar
- Number keys: 0–9

Try These Code Recipes!

Move Right

```
When [right arrow] key pressed  
move 10 steps
```

Move Left

```
When [left arrow] key pressed  
move -10 steps
```

Move Up

```
When [up arrow] key pressed  
change y by 10
```

Move Down

```
When [down arrow] key pressed  
change y by -10
```

Make It Talk

```
When [s] key pressed  
say "Hello!" for 2 seconds
```

Change Costume

```
When [c] key pressed  
next costume
```

Play a Sound

```
when [m] key pressed
play sound [Meow] until done
```

Tip: "y" controls the up/down direction of your sprite, and a minus sign means go backwards or down!

Mini Project: Keyboard Pet!

Build your own keyboard-controlled pet:

- 1 Pick a cute animal sprite
- 2 Arrow keys → move it around
- 3 Press S → it says "Feed me!"
- 4 Press C → it changes costume
- 5 Press M → it makes a sound

Your pet listens to YOUR keys!

What Did We Learn? — Checklist

Events tell Scratch WHEN to act	■
"When key pressed" listens for keyboard keys	■
We can move, talk, change costume, and play sounds	■
Many keys can work together in one project	■

Try It Yourself!

Pick TWO more keys and write down what you want them to do. Then build it in Scratch!

Key I pick	What it should do

You are now a Scratch Events pro! Keep exploring — try adding more keys and more actions at home. Happy Coding!